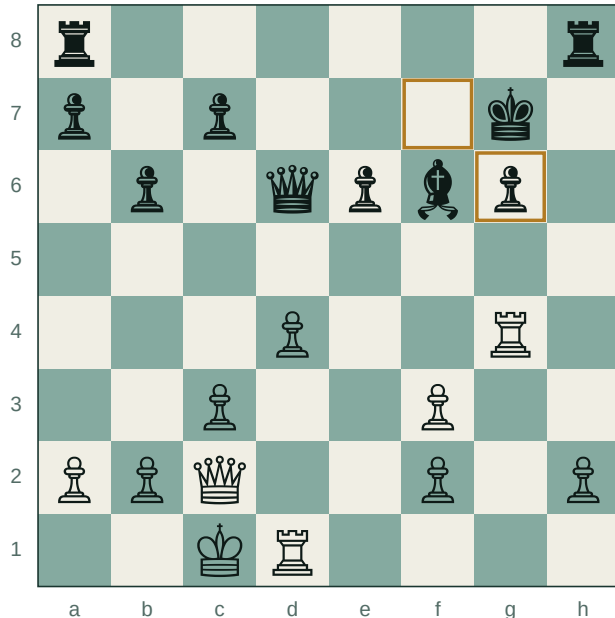


Deflection tactics: White, move 19

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 18...fxg6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Qxg6+ Kf8 20. Qxf6+

19.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g6 it attacks king on g7 and bishop on f6. Recorded reply: **19...Kf8**.

20.Qxf6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f6 it attacks king on f8 and rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.